AEROSPACE AND DEFENSE INDUSTRY REPORT

Aerospace and Defense Digest #86

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Golden Dome SBIs, DRS maritime C-UAS, AV MRR, Anduril USVs, P&W capacity expansion, Skydio raise, SpaceX/Cursor

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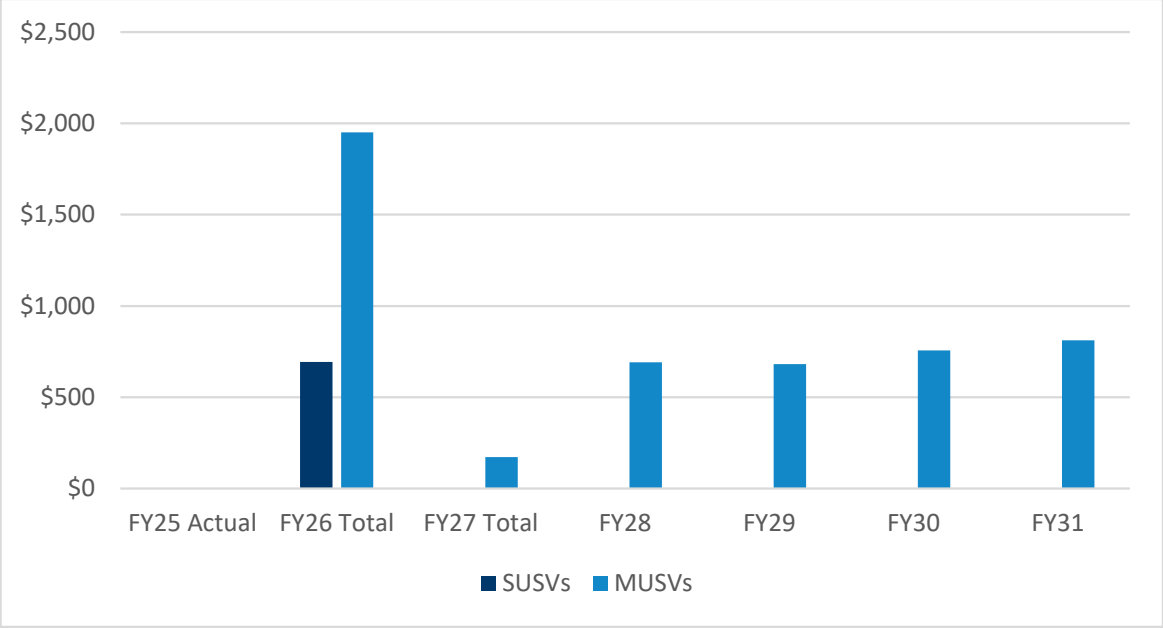
WHAT YOU SHOULD KNOW: Welcome to the Aerospace & Defense Digest, where we highlight a few key stories and themes from the prior week and break down their implications for our coverage and the broader industry. In this edition: the Space Force's Space-Based Interceptor (SBI) program, Leonardo DRS (DRS, Buy, $50 PT) integrating its Maritime Mission Equipment Package (M-MEP) onto an unmanned surface vessel (USV), AV (AVAV, Buy, $330 PT) being selected for the Army's Medium Range Reconaissance (MRR) program, Anduril's (Private) USV strategy, Pratt & Whitney's (RTX, Not Rated) $100mn investments in OEM and MRO capacity, Skydio (Private) raising a $110mn Series F at a $4.4bn valuation, and SpaceX (Private) acquiring Cursor (Private) for $60bn.

- **Space Force awards 20 OTAs to 12 companies worth cumulative $3.2bn for SBI program.** The program is designed to develop a space-based missile defense interceptor system that will demonstrate capability integrated into Golden Dome by 2028. The companies awarded include: Anduril, Booz Allen Hamilton (BAH, Not Rated), General Dynamics (GD, Neutral), GITAI (Private), Lockheed Martin (LMT, Not Rated), Northrop Grumman (NOC, Buy, $815 PT), Quindar (Private), Raytheon (RTX, Not Rated), Sci-Tec (FLY, Not Rated), SpaceX, True Anomaly (Private), and Turion Space Corp (Private). **OUR TAKE:** Details remain limited, but we contest that the cost of SBIs would exceed $3.2bn and the development would take longer than two years. Additionally, the technical feasibility of SBIs remains in question.
- **DRS integrates M-MEP on USV.** The system, which is designed for rapid integration on crewed and uncrewed platforms, was integrated onto the Sea Machines (Private) STORMRUNNER USV and showcased at Sea-Air-Space. **OUR TAKE:** According to DoW documents, the FY27 budget request includes $20.6bn for C-UAS. We expect DRS to be a prime beneficiary of this spending as C-UAS and broader air defense makes up ~20% of total company sales.
- **AV selected for MRR program.** It was awarded a $14.6mn production contract for its VAPOR drone. Additionally, the company announced it successfully demonstrated its LOCUST laser weapon system on the USS George H.W. Bush aircraft carrier last fall. **OUR TAKE:** The Army requested $291.5mn in FY27 for its Small Unmanned Aircraft Systems procurement line item, which includes funding for the Army's SRR, MRR, and LRR programs. AV is one of two contractors on the LRR program (alongside Redwire [RDW, Not Rated]) and one of multiple on MRR (alongside Quantum Systems [Private], Anduril, and more). However, we expect LRR funding to be meaningfully larger than MRR.
- **Anduril provides update on its entry into the USV market.** It is partnering with HD Hyundai (KRX: 267250, Not Rated) and Edison Chouest Offshore (Private) to design and produce medium USVs (MUSVs), with the first HD Hyundai hull already under construction and on track for water testing by year's end. It also partnered with Kraken (Private) to produce small USVs (SUSVs). **OUR TAKE:** Anduril first announced its partnership with HD Hyundai in November 2025 (see A&D Digest #64). It was meant to target the Navy's Modular Attack Surface Craft (MASC) program, but the program was canceled in March (see A&D Digest #82). It is now targeting the Navy's MUSV program, which received $2.0bn in FY26 funding and has a FY27 budget request of $171.1mn. In terms of the Kraken partnership, SUSVs received $694.0mn in FY26 funding but funding from FY27 on is expected to be negligible. See Exhibit 1 for more.

- **Pratt & Whitney investing $100mn to increase Poland production capacity, another $100mn to expand US MRO footprint.** The production capacity aims to add advanced capabilities and meet demand for the GTF, F135, and F100 engines, while the maintenance capacity is intended to speed up the GTF engine MRO process. **OUR TAKE:** The production capacity expansion follows the $200mn investment to expand forging capacity (see A&D Digest #78), with both moves coming in wake of pressure from OEMs to increase output. The MRO expansion is another proofpoint that the commercial aerospace aftermarket remains robust, in our view.
- **Skydio raises $110mn Series F at $4.4bn valuation, commits $3.5bn to expand US manufacturing.** This nearly doubles its $2.2bn valuation at the time of its 2024 Series E. It also plans to invest $3.5bn over the next five years to domestic manufacturing, accelerate R&D, and strengthen its supply chain. **OUR TAKE:** We view Skydio as a leader in the SUAS space. It recently received a $52mn US Army contract for 2,500 of its X10D drones (the largest order from a single vendor in Army history). Skydio is one of two companies supporting the Army's SRR program (other is Red Cat [RCAT, Not Rated]).
- **SpaceX agrees to acquire Cursor for $60bn.** SpaceX has been granted the option to acquire Cursor later this year for $60bn, or alternatively pay $10bn for resources used during the partnership. **OUR TAKE:** The deal is part of Musk's broader strategy to transform SpaceX into an AI powerhouse. The combination makes sense in our view: Cursor brings a leading AI coding product with strong distribution among expert software engineers, while SpaceX contributes its Colossus supercomputer, data from X, and significant capital resources.

Exhibit 1 - Navy SUSV and MUSV procurement budget

The Navy requested $171.1mn for MUSVs in FY27, but just $585k for SUSVs



Source: BTIG Research, DoW

Notable contract awards for the week of April 20-April 24:

- **April 20:** $213.4mn cost-plus-incentive-fee, cost-plus-fixed-fee, and cost-only modification to Raytheon Missiles and Defense (RTX, Not Rated) to exercise options in support of combat system installation, integration, development, testing, correction, maintenance, and modernization of Zumwalt-class mission systems and mission system equipment.
- **April 22:** $57.3mn firm-fixed-price contract to SpaceX (Private) for the Link-182 Space-to-Space Comms System Development and Demonstrations.
- **April 23:** $369.9mn contract modification to RTX for Lot 21 F135 Propulsion Systems and Lot 20 advanced long lead time materials, parts, components, and efforts; $10.8mn firm-fixed-price, IDIQ contract to Kratos Unmanned Aerial Systems (KTOS, Buy, $115 PT) for the procurement of BQM-177A Subsonic Aerial Target pre-expended bin replenishment components and post-flight consumable components in support of required flight testing for the Navy.
- **April 24:** $105.0mn modification to a firm-fixed-price order to Castelion (Private), exercising an option in support of Small Business Innovation Research Phase III effort, topic AF231-D026, entitled “Low Cost Highly Manufacturable Long Range Strike

Weapon Production", to provide final early operational capability requirements, provide test and integration configurations of the Blackbeard Hypersonic Weapon, and complete live fire test events in the Indo-Pacific Command area of responsibility. See our Castelion Spotlight for more about the company.

Aerospace & Defense Compsheet

Company	Ticker	EV	Market Cap	Current Price	BTIG Rating	Price Target	Implied Upside	2026 EV/EBITDA	2027 EV/EBITDA	2028 EV/EBITDA	2026 P/E	2027 P/E	2028 P/E	2026 P/FCF	2027 P/FCF	2028 P/FCF
Defense Primes																
Boeing	BA	$223,489	$183,233	$232	Not Rated	-		46.6x	26.4x	19.5x	1,107.5x	53.4x	29.9x	78.8x	27.5x	19.1x
General Dynamics	GD	$92,555	$84,832	$313	Neutral	-		13.8x	12.8x	12.1x	19.2x	17.3x	16.0x	19.3x	18.0x	16.7x
Huntington Ingalls Industries	HII	$16,312	$14,148	$359	Not Rated	-		15.8x	13.5x	12.3x	21.6x	18.2x	16.0x	25.1x	21.2x	18.7x
Lockheed Martin	LMT	$142,038	$118,383	$513	Not Rated	-		12.1x	11.6x	11.3x	17.2x	16.0x	15.0x	17.8x	18.1x	17.1x
L3Harris	LHX	$69,904	$59,303	$318	Not Rated	-		16.2x	14.9x	13.5x	26.9x	23.2x	20.1x	19.7x	19.0x	17.4x
Northrop Grumman	NOC	$95,135	$81,685	$575	Buy	$815	41.7%	15.6x	14.8x	14.0x	20.6x	19.1x	17.6x	25.1x	23.8x	22.3x
RTX	RTX	$270,630	$234,672	$174	Not Rated	-		17.7x	16.3x	14.9x	25.3x	23.0x	20.8x	27.8x	24.0x	21.6x
Defense Primes Market Cap Weighted Average								**22.9x**	**17.3x**	**14.9x**	**278.4x**	**28.0x**	**21.1x**	**36.4x**	**22.8x**	**19.5x**
Defense Primes Market Cap Weighted Average excl. BA								**15.6x**	**14.5x**	**13.5x**	**22.2x**	**20.2x**	**18.3x**	**23.3x**	**21.4x**	**19.6x**
Defense Primes Market Cap Weighted Average excl. BA & RTX								**14.1x**	**13.2x**	**12.5x**	**20.2x**	**18.3x**	**16.7x**	**20.4x**	**19.6x**	**18.3x**
Defense Tech																
AV	AVAV	$9,906	$9,801	$196	Buy	$330	68.1%	28.2x	22.3x	17.2x	48.7x	36.8x	26.3x	74.3x	57.3x	
AIRO Group	AIRO	$182	$249	$8	Neutral	-		16.7x	4.6x	2.9x						
BWX Technologies	BWXT	$22,096	$20,443	$223	Buy	$235	5.3%	33.7x	29.5x	27.2x	48.4x	43.0x	38.8x	63.3x	59.3x	52.5x
Curtiss-Wright	CW	$27,262	$26,482	$718	Not Rated	-		33.3x	30.1x	26.4x	47.6x	43.0x	38.2x	45.2x	42.4x	39.6x
Karman Space & Defense	KRMN	$9,771	$9,306	$70	Not Rated	-		46.2x	35.5x	27.5x	106.7x	72.1x	52.5x	182.4x	101.8x	73.5x
Kratos Defense & Security Solutions	KTOS	$11,119	$11,482	$61	Buy	$115	87.7%	58.9x	43.0x	33.6x	79.0x	58.0x	44.9x			175.0x
Leonardo DRS	DRS	$10,472	$10,633	$40	Buy	$50	25.1%	20.4x	18.1x	16.8x	31.9x	28.3x	25.8x	39.8x	33.6x	29.2x
Mercury Systems	MRCY	$5,114	$4,681	$78	Not Rated	-		35.4x	25.3x	20.8x	81.3x	51.9x	38.4x	55.3x	42.7x	32.9x
Redwire	RDW	$2,102	$1,926	$10	Not Rated	-		168.6x	36.8x							
Defense Tech Market Cap Weighted Average								**38.6x**	**29.8x**	**25.2x**	**57.6x**	**45.9x**	**37.9x**	**68.8x**	**54.1x**	**63.6x**
Federal Services																
Amentum	AMTM	$9,891	$6,301	$26	Buy	$35	35.4%	9.0x	8.4x	8.0x	10.7x	9.4x	8.5x	11.6x	9.6x	8.4x
Booz Allen Hamilton	BAH	$12,558	$9,496	$79	Not Rated	-		10.2x	9.7x		12.6x	11.4x		10.4x	9.6x	
CACI International	CACI	$16,550	$11,411	$517	Not Rated	-		14.8x	12.8x	11.9x	18.3x	16.3x	14.4x	16.0x	15.0x	13.8x
KBR	KBR	$6,490	$4,467	$35	Not Rated	-		7.0x	6.7x	6.1x	8.9x	8.5x	7.9x	7.5x	7.0x	
Leidos	LDOS	$22,171	$18,393	$146	Not Rated	-		9.5x	9.1x	8.7x	11.9x	11.2x	10.4x	13.2x	11.3x	10.4x
MAXIMUS	MMS	$5,039	$3,571	$65	Not Rated	-		6.8x	6.4x		7.7x	7.2x				
Parsons	PSN	$6,553	$5,720	$53	Not Rated	-		10.8x	10.0x	9.6x	16.4x	14.5x	12.7x	14.2x	13.1x	
Science Applications International Corp.	SAIC	$6,551	$4,151	$96	Not Rated	-		9.8x	9.6x		9.9x	8.9x	7.8x	6.7x	6.8x	
V2X	VVX	$2,747	$1,979	$63	Buy	$90	42.2%	8.0x	7.4x	6.9x	10.9x	9.7x	8.4x	12.1x	8.9x	7.8x
Federal Services Market Cap Weighted Average								**10.2x**	**9.5x**	**9.2x**	**12.8x**	**11.6x**	**10.8x**	**12.3x**	**11.0x**	**11.0x**
Commercial Aerospace																
AAR	AIR	$5,291	$4,396	$111	Not Rated	-		11.6x	10.4x	9.1x	19.5x	16.7x	14.7x	41.6x	32.4x	42.2x
AerSale	ASLE	$451	$325	$7	Not Rated	-		7.9x	6.8x		10.3x	7.6x		80.9x	7.8x	
Airbus	EADSF	$126,209	$152,329	$194	Not Rated	-		12.0x	10.4x	8.9x				30.0x	22.2x	16.7x
ATI	ATI	$22,661	$21,051	$154	Buy	$165	7.0%	23.1x	20.0x	17.9x	36.7x	30.1x	25.9x	45.2x	38.6x	32.1x
Boeing	BA	$223,489	$183,233	$232	Not Rated	-		46.6x	26.4x	19.5x	1,107.5x	53.4x	29.9x	78.8x	27.5x	19.1x
Carpenter Technology	CRS	$22,259	$21,293	$427	Buy	$375	-12.3%	26.3x	22.4x	19.2x	41.6x	35.2x	29.9x			
FTAI Aviation	FTAI	$27,273	$23,886	$233	Buy	$340	46.0%	18.0x	12.5x	9.6x	30.6x	18.4x	12.6x	26.3x	16.6x	10.2x
GE Aerospace	GE	$313,271	$296,935	$285	Not Rated	-		26.7x	24.1x	21.6x	37.6x	33.1x	29.0x	35.9x	31.6x	28.2x
Heico	HEI	$35,042	$36,838	$264	Not Rated	-		29.2x	26.5x	24.6x	46.1x	41.2x	36.8x	42.4x	36.9x	34.6x
Hexcel	HXL	$7,818	$6,742	$89	Not Rated	-		19.6x	16.5x	14.6x	39.5x	29.2x	23.9x	35.4x	26.6x	21.8x
Howmet Aerospace	HWM	$100,528	$97,149	$242	Buy	$275	13.4%	35.3x	30.4x	26.7x	52.2x	43.6x	37.1x	59.2x	48.7x	41.6x
Loar	LOAR	$6,057	$5,367	$57	Not Rated	-		24.0x	21.6x	19.7x	72.4x	54.3x	43.4x	51.2x	38.5x	34.5x
Moog	MOG.A	$11,221	$9,927	$313	Not Rated	-		17.9x	16.3x		30.7x	27.2x	25.3x	52.6x	32.4x	
RTX	RTX	$270,630	$234,672	$174	Not Rated	-		17.7x	16.3x	14.9x	25.3x	23.0x	20.8x	27.8x	24.0x	21.6x
StandardAero	SARO	$10,111	$8,163	$25	Buy	$35	42.6%	11.6x	10.2x	9.1x	17.4x	14.3x	12.1x	29.3x	21.1x	16.5x
Textron	TXT	$17,357	$15,314	$88	Not Rated	-		9.9x	9.2x	8.4x	13.6x	12.0x	10.8x	21.2x	15.4x	10.9x
Transdigm	TDG	$94,529	$64,842	$1,148	Not Rated	-		17.9x	16.3x	14.9x	32.6x	28.7x	24.9x	29.6x	25.3x	22.5x
Woodward	WWD	$22,841	$21,757	$365	Not Rated	-		27.1x	23.9x	21.0x	41.6x	35.7x	30.3x	64.8x	44.5x	34.4x
Commercial Aerospace Market Cap Weighted Average								**25.7x**	**20.6x**	**17.8x**	**222.1x**	**34.5x**	**27.3x**	**42.4x**	**29.3x**	**24.5x**

Source: BTIG Research, FactSet

All forward estimates are FactSet consensus estimates. All price targets are BTIG Research estimates.

Aerospace & Defense Compsheet (cont.)

Company	Ticker	EV	Market Cap	Current Price		Price Target	Implied Upside	2026 EV/Sales	2027 EV/Sales	2028 EV/Sales
Space										
BlackSky Technology	BKSY	$1,499	$1,255	$34	Not Rated	-		9.2x	7.2x	6.0x
Firefly Aerospace	FLY	$5,685	$5,625	$35	Not Rated	-		11.6x	7.2x	4.4x
Intuitive Machines	LUNR	$5,554	$4,069	$26	Not Rated	-		3.9x	3.3x	2.6x
Karman Space & Defense	KRMN	$9,771	$9,306	$70	Not Rated	-		13.6x	10.7x	8.4x
Planet Labs	PL	$14,072	$12,268	$35	Not Rated	-		25.1x	19.0x	14.4x
Redwire	RDW	$2,102	$1,926	$10	Not Rated	-		2.7x	2.2x	
Rocket Lab	RKLB	$52,320	$45,877	$80	Neutral	-		48.3x	33.8x	26.0x
Spire Global	SPIR	$531	$554	$17	Not Rated	-		5.8x	4.8x	
Virgin Galactic	SPCE	$198	$210	$3	Not Rated	-		4.3x	0.5x	0.3x
Voyager Technologies	VOYG	$1,769	$1,696	$29	Not Rated	-		7.1x	4.7x	2.3x
Space Market Cap Weighted Average								**33.4x**	**23.7x**	**18.6x**

Company	Ticker	EV	Market Cap	Current Price		Price Target	Implied Upside	2026 EV/Sales	2027 EV/Sales	2028 EV/Sales
eVTOL										
AIRO Group	AIRO	$182	$249	$8	Neutral	-		1.1x	0.7x	0.4x
Archer Aviation	ACHR	$2,742	$4,244	$6	Not Rated	-		118.7x	14.9x	3.3x
BETA Technologies	BETA	$2,237	$3,513	$15	Buy	$40	161.6%	49.6x	5.3x	2.0x
Eve	EVEX	$808	$965	$3	Neutral	-		1,219.4x	7.1x	1.3x
Joby Aviation	JOBY	$7,342	$8,324	$9	Not Rated	-		50.3x	25.5x	12.2x
Vertical Aerospace	EVTL	$469	$302	$2	Not Rated	-				6.7x
eVTOL Market Cap Weighted Average								**131.4x**	**17.4x**	**7.2x**

Source: BTIG Research, FactSet

All forward estimates are FactSet consensus estimates. All price targets are BTIG Research estimates.

BTIG Covered Companies Mentioned in this Report

AIRO Group Holdings (AIRO, Neutral, Closing Price: $7.93)
ATI, Inc. (ATI, Buy, $165 PT; Closing Price: $154.26)
AeroVironment (AVAV, Buy, $330 PT; Closing Price: $196.28)
Amentum Holdings (AMTM, Buy, $35 PT; Closing Price: $25.85)
BETA Technologies, Inc. (BETA, Buy, $40 PT; Closing Price: $15.29)
BWX Technologies, Inc. (BWXT, Buy, $235 PT; Closing Price: $223.15)
Carpenter Technology Corp. (CRS, Buy, $375 PT; Closing Price: $427.48)
Eve Holding, Inc. (EVEX, Neutral, Closing Price: $2.77)
FTAI Aviation Ltd. (FTAI, Buy, $340 PT; Closing Price: $232.85)
General Dynamics (GD, Neutral, Closing Price: $313.21)
Howmet Aerospace Inc. (HWM, Buy, $275 PT; Closing Price: $242.44)
Kratos Defense & Security Solutions (KTOS, Buy, $115 PT; Closing Price: $61.26)
Leonardo DRS (DRS, Buy, $50 PT; Closing Price: $39.98)
Northrop Grumman (NOC, Buy, $815 PT; Closing Price: $575.11)
Rocket Lab (RKLB, Neutral, Closing Price: $79.68)
StandardAero (SARO, Buy, $35 PT; Closing Price: $24.54)
V2X (VVX, Buy, $90 PT; Closing Price: $63.29)

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